hemoglobin that is not phagocytized is broken down in the ~~circ~~ circulation → releasing alpha- beta chains that are removed from circulation by the kidneys

Iron contained in the heme portion of hemoglobin may be stored in the liver → spleen, primarily in the form of ferritin or hemosiderin // or carried through the bloodstream by transferrin to the red bone marrow for recycling to new RPCs

. The None-Iron portion of heme is degraded into the waste product **biliverdin**

Biliverdin → is a green pigment → then another waste product ?> Bilirubin ← yellow pigment

Bilirubin binds to the albumin & travels in the blood to the liver, which uses it in the manufacture of Bile → a compound released into the intestines to = help emulsify dietry fats.

In the large intestine → bacteria breaks ~~down~~ bilirubin apart from the bile & converts it to urobilinogen & then into stercobilin } eliminated from body by feces - This is why → Broad Spectrum antibiotics typically eliminate these bacteria → may alter hue of feces

The Kidneys also remove any circulating bilirubin & other related metabolic bi-products such as urobilins & secrete into urine.

Bruises -> breakdown from destruction of hemoglobin can be seen in a variety of situations ->

Jaundice → failing liver / yellowish tinge.

~~Steco~~ Stercobilins → within feces produce typical ~~bl~~ brown → & yellow of urine of urobilins